



Fact Sheet

This document is for connecting applicants to help understand AEMO's fees and charges related to the connections and registrations processes.

AEMO's connections role

Across the National Electricity Market (NEM), AEMO performs an advisory role in assessing and negotiating performance standards for connecting assets to assure the stable and secure performance of the power system. AEMO also assesses simulation models of power system plant and associated control systems and performs commissioning and post-commissioning activities. This is the case for all connections in the NEM across both transmission and distribution networks. AEMO is also responsible for approving the registration of connecting plant into the NEM.

AEMO's revenue and fees model

AEMO is a not-for-profit organisation, operating on a full cost-recovery basis. As a member-based organisation, funded by registered participants, we are committed to transparent and accountable financial and risk management.

Annually, AEMO establishes revenue requirements for performing its functions and delivering its priorities and publishes this in its Budget and Fees document.

AEMO's revenue requirement is determined by establishing efficient and prudent levels of expenditure for the functions and services it provides. Revenue

requirements are applied to established fees and charges structures, which apply to market participants that benefit from the relevant functions or services.

Connection and registration fees are charged to the connecting/registering market participant.

Connections charge-out rates

The charge-out rates (hourly) which apply for AEMO's connection role are reviewed and updated each year. These rates reflect both direct (e.g., labour cost) and indirect (e.g., management, legal, digital, training and travel) costs. Fees are charged on a time and materials basis using these charge-out rates and invoiced monthly.

In FY26, AEMO's charge-out rates for activities related to assessing and progressing connections have decreased on average by 1.4% across all roles, primarily reflecting consumer price index changes and labour costs.

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Table 1 AEMO connection charge-out rates FY26

Description	\$/hour rate (excl. GST)	% Increase
Analyst/Engineer	\$345	NIL
Senior	\$375	(1.3%)
Principal	\$420	(1.2%)
Manager, Specialist	\$480	(3.0%)
Third Party Labour¹	Cost+15%	-
Site Visits²	Rate per hour + (15% for third-party labour) including travel time and travel expense	-
Connections Reform Initiative³	\$30	-

¹ Applies to contractors, consultants or specialist advisors that AEMO engages on a fixed fee basis to support its activities.

² AEMO employees and/or contractors may attend site to oversee testing (in accordance with clause 5.8.5(a) of the NER)

³ AEMO and the Clean Energy Council established the Connections Reform Initiative (CRI) to address concerns with delays and increasing complexity in connections to the NEM. To recover costs for dedicated work undertaken for the CRI, a \$30/hour uplift will be applied to AEMO Onboarding and Connections (AEMO advisory function) charges. This uplift is not applied for activities undertaken in Victoria as the connecting TNSP.

Registration fees

Since 2020, the NEM registration fee has increased solely to reflect annual indexation. Over this period, AEMO has seen the complexity of requirements and scope of assessments increase substantially, driven by increasing connection volumes and the introduction of new technologies. For AEMO to continue supporting onboarding and registration activities effectively, it was important to establish a cost reflective fee structure for registration.

AEMO has completed a detailed, bottom-up review and updated its registration fees to ensure they appropriately reflect the effort expended for each registration type. This ensures that costs are being recovered from the appropriate party.

Third party costs incurred by AEMO in the process of registering a participant are included within the registration fee.

A complete list of registration fees, and information on how they have changed from FY25, is within AEMO's [FY26 Budget and Fees](#).

Share your feedback and find out more

AEMO is committed to continuously improving its services and engagement with its stakeholders. If you have questions about the connections process or feedback about how we can improve, we would love to hear from you.

For enquiries about:

- the connections process and fees for the NEM (excluding Victoria), please email AEMO's Connections team at Contact.Connections@aemo.com.au
- Registrations please email Onboarding@aemo.com.au